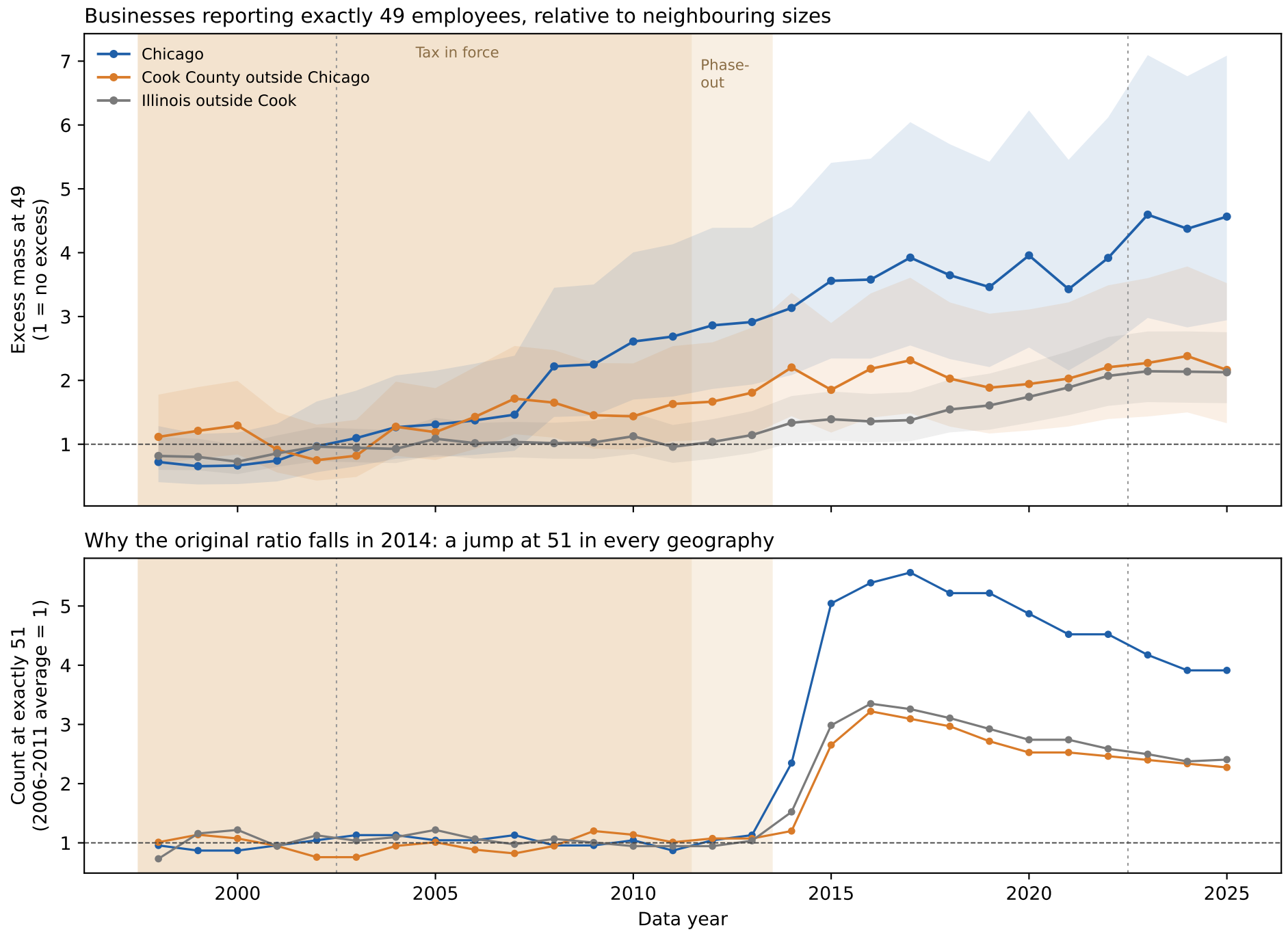


No robust evidence of bunching below the old 50-employee threshold



Difference-in-differences, 2003-2011 vs 2014-2022 (log points, 95% CI): Chicago vs Cook outside Chicago -0.33 (-0.63 to -0.03); vs Illinois outside Cook -0.29 (-0.53 to -0.04). Ratio = count at 49 / mean count at 46-48 and 52-54 (51 skipped, see lower panel). Single-location businesses with verified headcounts; 1997 excluded. Shading: tax in force (dark), phase-out (light). Dotted lines: vendor coding changes. Source: Data Axle (Infogroup) historical business files.